

Elvis Rafael Gross Cardero

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Dear Hiring Manager,

I am writing to express my interest in a Cloud Operations or Site Reliability Engineering role at your organization. With over seven years of combined experience in cloud infrastructure operations and pre-sales cloud architecture — including production AWS work at International Game Technology (IGT) supporting mission-critical gaming workloads at enterprise scale — I bring a hands-on technical foundation, five active cloud certifications, and a strong operational mindset focused on reliability, automation, and observability.

Most recently, as a Cloud Operations Engineer at IGT, I managed multi-account AWS environments supporting gaming infrastructure serving millions of end users across a 13-month engagement. My work centered on three core areas: infrastructure operations across EC2, EKS, IAM, and S3; automation through AWS Systems Manager — leveraging SSM Patch Manager, Run Command, and Automation Documents to manage patch compliance across fleets of 200+ Linux and Windows instances; and observability through CloudWatch, where I implemented custom alarms, log-based alerting, and Container Insights dashboards to reduce mean time to detection for production incidents. I also led EKS cluster version upgrades in production using a Golden AMI strategy, achieving zero-downtime node rotations through controlled drain and cordon workflows. I owned backup and disaster recovery strategies aligned to defined RTO/RPO targets, including DR testing cycles and runbook documentation ensuring repeatable recovery procedures.

Prior to IGT, I spent over three years as a Pre-Sales Cloud Engineer at CODESA, a Google Cloud Partner IT consulting firm, where I architected and delivered production-ready GCP solutions for enterprise clients. This experience gave me a rare combination of infrastructure depth and communication skills — I designed IAM frameworks, real-time data pipelines using Pub/Sub and BigQuery, and serverless architectures with Cloud Run and Cloud Functions, while presenting architecture decisions directly to executive stakeholders. That background translates directly into my ability to operate across multi-cloud environments and communicate technical complexity clearly to non-technical audiences. I hold five active certifications: AWS Certified SysOps Administrator (CloudOps), Google Cloud Professional Cloud Architect (PCA), Google Cloud Associate Cloud Engineer (ACE), CompTIA Cloud+, and ISC2 Certified in Cybersecurity (CC). I am actively pursuing the Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) certification, supported by hands-on homelab practice with a multi-node Kubernetes cluster provisioned from scratch — covering CNI configuration, RBAC, scheduling, persistent storage, and pod lifecycle management.

I am based in Las Vegas, NV, hold an active Nevada Gaming License, and am open to both on-site and remote opportunities. I am confident that my production experience in AWS operations, my cross-cloud architecture background, and my commitment to operational excellence make me a strong contributor to any cloud infrastructure or SRE team.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my background aligns with your team's needs. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Sincerely,

Elvis Rafael Gross Cardero